

The mosque. Picture by Muhammad Mahdi Karim

Another clue to its Islamic influences is the relative lack of adornment. In the Indian subcontinent, Hindu temples are often festooned with images of gods, demons and other mythological beings, and in some cases, like the famous temples of the southern city of Madurai, the temples' facades appear to be composed entirely of such images[18]. In contrast, the Muslim buildings are decorated with geometric patterns, images of plants and elaborate Arabic calligraphy.